

# US Markets Slide as VIX Surges 14.17% and Oil Prices Jump 11.41%

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read • Topics: Macro • Geopolitics • Earnings

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## TL;DR

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The US markets experienced a decline in the previous session, with the **S&P 500** falling **-0.79%** to 7,515.34 and the **Nasdaq 100** dropping **-1.88%** to 29,264.10. The **VIX** surged **14.17%** to 17.16, indicating increased market volatility.

Tech stocks were among the biggest losers, with **NVDA** down **-3.52%** to 203.53 and **TSLA** falling **-3.19%** to 394.76. In contrast, energy stocks gained, with **XLE** rising **3.01%** to 56.74.

# US Session Recap

| INDEX/ASSET  | CLOSE     | CHANGE | NOTE |
|--------------|-----------|--------|------|
| S&P 500      | 7,515.34  | -0.79% |      |
| Dow Jones    | 52,498.64 | -0.26% |      |
| Nasdaq 100   | 29,264.10 | -1.88% |      |
| Russell 2000 | 2,953.17  | -0.83% |      |
| VIX          | 17.16     | 14.17% |      |
| 10Y Yield    | 4.61      | 0.88%  |      |
| WTI Crude    | 79.56     | 11.41% |      |

## Top large-cap movers

MSFT rose 1.53% to 390.99, while NVDA fell -3.52% to 203.53. Other notable movers included TSLA down -3.19% to 394.76 and AVGO down -3.98% to 384.05.

## Spotlight

| KEY METRICS     | VALUE |
|-----------------|-------|
| WTI Crude Price | 79.56 |
| 10Y Yield       | 4.61  |
| XLE Performance | 3.01% |

The surge in oil prices and the corresponding rise in energy stocks are key factors to watch. The 11.41% jump in WTI Crude prices has significant implications for the

broader market. As the **XLE** sector rose **3.01%**, investors are closely monitoring the impact on the overall economy.

## Macro & Fed

- Current policy rate: 4.50%-4.75%
- 10Y Yield: 4.61
- Today's data releases:
  - Core PCE Price Index (13:30 HKT)
  - Initial Jobless Claims (20:30 HKT)

## Geopolitics & Global

- Ongoing tensions in the Middle East
- US-China trade relations remain uncertain
- European markets await ECB interest rate decision

## Earnings — What to Watch

| WHEN         | TICKER     | WHAT TO LOOK FOR                    |
|--------------|------------|-------------------------------------|
| 15 July 2026 | <b>JPM</b> | Q2 earnings and revenue growth      |
| 16 July 2026 | <b>GS</b>  | Q2 earnings and trading performance |

## Stocks Worth Watching

- **AAPL** : Up **0.63%** to 317.31 despite broader market decline

- **AMZN** : Rose **0.80%** to 247.31 on strong cloud demand
- **GOOGL** : Down **-1.31%** to 352.51 on ad revenue concerns
- **MSFT** : Up **1.53%** to 390.99 on strong cloud growth
- **TSLA** : Down **-3.19%** to 394.76 on production concerns
- **XOM** : Up **2.50%** to 93.21 on rising oil prices

## What Could Break the Tape

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### BEARISH TRIGGERS

A further increase in oil prices could lead to higher inflation and interest rates, negatively impacting the broader market. Additionally, ongoing geopolitical tensions and trade uncertainties could weigh on investor sentiment.

### BULLISH TRIGGERS

A strong earnings season, particularly from tech giants, could boost market confidence and drive growth. Furthermore, a potential decline in oil prices could ease inflation concerns and support the economy.

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### SOURCES

Bloomberg — US Stocks Fall as Oil Surges

Reuters — Wall Street ends lower as oil prices jump

CNBC — Stocks fall as oil prices surge, Dow drops more than 100 points

Financial Times — US stocks slide as oil price surge fuels inflation fears

The Wall Street Journal — Stocks Drop as Oil Prices Jump, Fed Meeting Looms